LUXURY LIVING CO.

The Art of the Tour

From showing spaces to creating connection.

Design brief · Learning experience for Leasing Associates
Brittany Blalock · November 2026



THE CHALLENGE

Tours are happening. Connection isn't.

Leadership sees four gaps in how Leasing Associates tour: they don't consistently build connection, they miss chances to personalize, amenities don't land, and next steps and follow-up are unclear. This brief covers how I'd close those gaps with a mobile learning experience built on the coaching-to-decision sales model, and how I'd run it as a program.

88%
of renters say a disorganized tour process changes their opinion of the property itself.
Rently renter survey, 2026

57%
still want a person to answer questions, even though self-guided is the most popular first step.
Rently renter survey, 2026

85% vs 40%
show rates for tours booked within three days versus a week or more out.
Zuma, 1.5M multifamily tours

Who I'm designing for

Where they work: on their feet, phone in hand, between walk-ins, calls and tours. Rarely at a desk.
Who they are: a mix of new hires and experienced agents who already know their community, the CRM and Fair Housing.

How they learn best: by doing and by watching peers. Experienced agents tune out anything that feels like starting over.
What they care about: signed leases, a good day on the floor, and being recognized for great service.

1 · APPROACH

What learners need to do differently

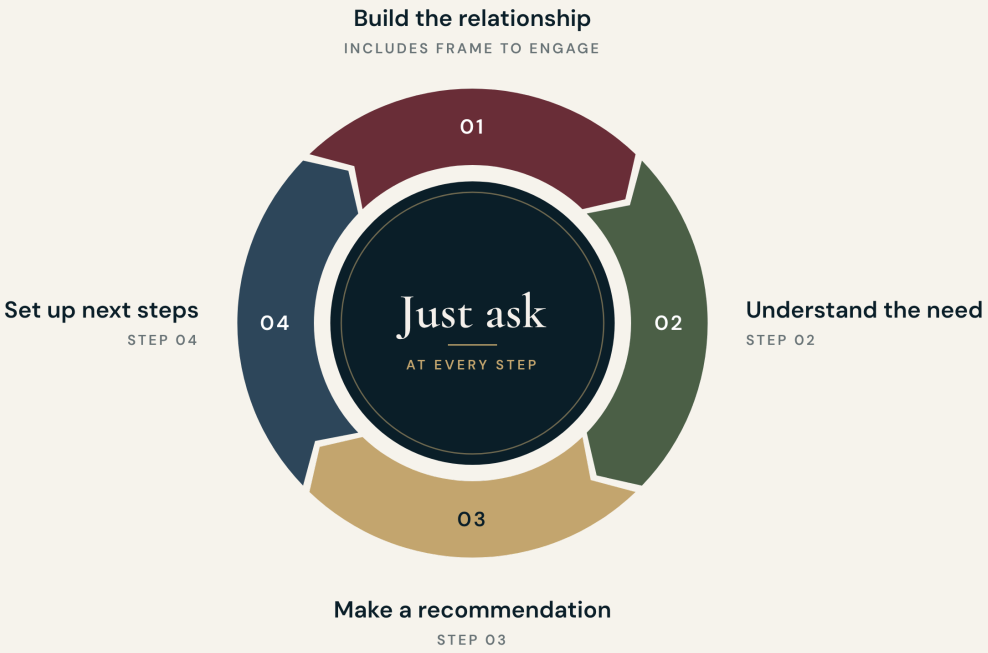
I diagnosed each observation before choosing a format. Most are skill gaps, one has a knowledge piece, and one is partly a system problem that training alone won't fix.

LEADERSHIP OBSERVED	GAP	MY DIAGNOSIS
Not building connection	SKILL	Associates are friendly, but tours start with the property instead of the person, and nobody frames the visit.
Missing chances to personalize	SKILL	Personalizing needs information the associate doesn't have yet. Without discovery questions, every tour follows the same route.
Amenities not landing	KNOWLEDGE + SKILL	Associates need to know who each amenity matters to, then recommend the few that fit instead of showing them all.
Unclear next steps and follow-up	SKILL + SYSTEM	Setting a next step and asking are skills. Following up in 24 hours also depends on workload and the CRM.

Adult learners bring a lot of experience with them, and leasing associates already know their properties well. Most of what I saw was a habit that needed to shift, and habits change through practice and feedback. So I kept the content light, focused it where it's needed, and built most of the experience around practice.

The coaching-to-decision sales model

Each gap maps to a step, and each step has a behavior a manager can see on a real tour. Asking sits at the center because it can happen at any step.



RELATIONSHIP — Greets the prospect by name, uses one detail from the inquiry, and *frames to engage*: shares a plan for the visit and checks it works.

NEED — Asks at least three open questions about life, timing and decision before showing a home.

RECOMMEND — Recommends one home and the two or three amenities that fit, and says why in the prospect's words.

NEXT STEPS — Agrees on a next step with a day and time, and sends a personal follow-up within 24 hours.

JUST ASK — Asks for the decision whenever the prospect shows a buying signal, at any step.

Why this approach and format

Mobile learning

Associates are on their phones throughout the day. Learning in short pieces on a device they already use feels natural, fits between tours, and stays there as a reference before their next one.

Practice over content

Associates already know their communities, so most of the time goes to deciding, practicing and getting feedback. Content is kept short and focused where there's a real knowledge gap.

The sales model as the backbone

Building on coaching-to-decision gives associates and managers one language for selling, training and coaching. Asking is taught as a habit at every step, not a final step.

Fair Housing built in

Personalization comes only from what the prospect chooses to share. The experience models asking instead of assuming, and compliance reviews every scenario before launch.

The learning experience

Built in Lovable as a mobile-first web app, in the Luxury Living Co. brand. One guided path in three stages, eight items in all, with progress tracking and a separate view for leaders.

1 Get started

A welcome video and a five-question pre-check that shows each associate where they're strong and where to focus.

2 Learn the model

Five short modules, one for each step of the model plus Just ask, each with practice decisions and feedback.

3 Put it together

A Fair Housing check, then the Tour Simulator, where associates run a full tour from hello to next steps.

3 · BEYOND THE EXPERIENCE

What keeps it going on the floor

A job aid

A quick reference on their phone with each step of the model, discovery questions and follow-up starters.

Manager coaching

Managers coach associates on real conversations with prospects, using the same steps, so feedback is specific and in the moment.

Follow-up surveys

Short check-ins after the training to see what's sticking and where associates still feel unsure.

Rollout plan

WEEKS 1–3

Discover

Tour Pulse survey, shadow tours, CRM baseline.

◇ Gap and baseline confirmed

WEEKS 4–8

Build

Finish the app, compliance review, manager briefing.

◇ Compliance sign-off

WEEKS 9–21

Pilot

3 to 5 communities for 90 days, with comparison communities.

◇ Scale, adjust, or stop

WEEK 22 ON

Scale

Roll out in waves; add to new-hire onboarding.

◇ Quarterly KPI review

Key risks

RISK	HOW I'D HANDLE IT
Managers don't have time to observe	A 10-minute checklist, observations in manager goals, regional check-ins
Discovery questions cross Fair Housing lines	Compliance review before launch; "ask, don't assume" in every scenario
The follow-up gap is a system problem	An automatic CRM task after every logged tour
Seasonality skews the results	Pilot vs. comparison communities against a 90-day baseline

4 · MEASUREMENT

How I'd know it worked

KIRKPATRICK LEVEL	EVALUATION METHOD
1 · Reaction	A two-question pulse at the end of each module, plus feedback community managers gather in team huddles.
2 · Learning	The pre-check, practice in each module, and the Tour Simulator, where associates see how each step of the model landed.
3 · Behavior	Managers observe a real tour at 30, 60 and 90 days. The CRM tracks personal follow-up within 24 hours.
4 · Results	Tour-to-lease conversion in pilot vs. comparison communities against a 90-day baseline, plus a short prospect survey.

KPI scorecard

MEASURE	TYPE	PROPOSED TARGET	OWNER	REPORTED
Completion	Leading	90% within 30 days	Program manager	Weekly
Confidence by step (pre/post survey)	Leading	+1 point on a 5-point scale	Program manager	Before and at 90 days
Observed behavior on real tours	Leading	Every associate observed by day 30	Community managers	Monthly
Follow-up within 24 hours	Leading	80% of tours	Operations	Weekly
Tour-to-lease conversion	Lagging	Pilot beats comparison	Regional leadership	Monthly, 90-day readout

Targets are proposed and would be set once the baseline is in.

5 · NEXT STEPS

What I'd learn, validate and develop

Learn from associates

- Send the Tour Pulse survey to set a baseline
- Shadow eight to ten tours
- Interview top performers about the first two minutes

Validate with SMEs

- Compliance review of every scenario
- Confirm what a great tour looks like at each step
- Pull CRM data to size the gap

Develop further

- Test the app with associates and managers
- Add a module for self-guided tours
- Use pilot results to decide whether to scale

SOURCES · Rently renter survey (800 U.S. renters), June 2026, via GlobeNewswire · Zuma, *Multifamily Tour Conversion Report* (1.5M tours, 1,000+ properties) · MRI Software, "Apartment leasing tours perform better with a personal touch," Oct 2020. Luxury Living Co. is a fictional company.